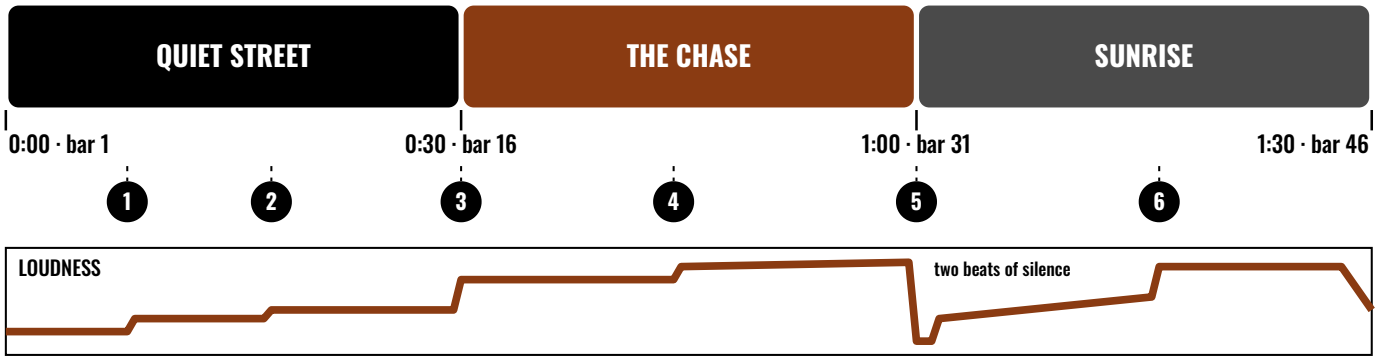
HUDSON BEAT



SCORE THE PICTURE
MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

DMP2 · mood · timing · hit points · markers · intro slides

GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 24 PAGES + 18-SLIDE DECK

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period scoring project for high school music technology. Each student chooses a 2–3 minute video clip and composes an original soundtrack for it in Logic Pro: music that matches the mood, pacing and emotional arc of the picture, with at least some elements timed to specific visual moments, called hit points. It is an open-ended project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (focus: scoring and sync), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order.

QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Decide how students will find a clip they may use (page 4): no video is included.
3. Print the student pages (pages 13–23), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–6), Class 2 (slides 7–11), Class 3 (slide 12), Class 4 (slide 13), Class 6 (slides 14–16) and Class 7 (slides 17–18). Class 5 is a working day with no new slide. Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

WHAT'S INSIDE ·

PART	PAGES	USE
Teacher pages	pages 2–12	How to use, overview, choosing a clip, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic reference, sync guide, composing to picture, worked example
Student pages	pages 13–23	Clip log, Watch notes, Score plan, Cue sheet, Sync log, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner
Intro deck (separate file)	deck	18 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide

NO VIDEO OR AUDIO INCLUDED

No video, audio, films, games or songs are included. Students use their own clip, or one they may use from a site such as YouTube or Vimeo, and choose it themselves (page 4), so you know exactly where every picture came from.

MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Clips:** students may film their own, so the project also works with no downloads at all.
- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6.
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 21).

IN ONE SENTENCE

Students pick a clip, study it, mark its key moments, compose a score that fits and hits them, and present the result.

Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Project overview

OVERVIEW

DMP2 · Open-Ended

FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU

Music for Visual Media · Open-Ended · Scoring & Sync
Score a video clip with an original soundtrack. Match mood, pacing, and timing to the visuals.

WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One Logic Pro score for a 2–3 minute video clip, with at least some musical elements timed to the picture and, if they like, sound effects. They hand in a bounced .mp3 or .wav, the zipped .logicx project, and a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then show the video with their music and talk through their choices.

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

This connects music production to real-world application in film, TV, games, and advertising. Builds synchronization skills, emotional storytelling through music, and arrangement for narrative purposes.

STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): refining original work (MU:Cr3.1), presenting it (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

GOALS ·

- Compose music that serves a visual narrative
- Develop synchronization skills — timing music to visual cues
- Explore mood, atmosphere, and pacing through musical choices
- Optionally incorporate sound effects to enhance the audio-visual experience

AT A GLANCE ·

Grades	9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics
Length	7 class periods: choose and study, plan, three working days, bounce, present
Software	Logic Pro: movie import, markers, SMPTE time, software instruments, tempo, volume automation, bounce
You supply	Video clips (students' own, or ones they may use), headphones, a feedback board, and speakers if you can
Assessment	My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 21)

BEFORE THEY START

Students should already know how to open a project, add software instruments, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. The Logic quick reference (page 9) covers every tool this project uses.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Setup and choosing a clip

SETUP

Teacher

YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with Logic Pro** for each student (a current version), and **headphones**. Speakers help for the final check that the music and the picture feel right together.
- **A video clip for every student**: their own footage, or one they may use. Nothing is included.
- **A place to submit** an .mp3 or .wav and a zipped .logicx project (your class page).
- **A feedback board** for the three questions (my sheets use Padlet).
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 13–23).

BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- [ ] Decide how clips will be chosen: your own footage, ones students find, or a short list you provide (my easier variation).
- [ ] Read the terms of the site students will use, so you can tell them what they may do with a clip.
- [ ] Pick one short scene you may show, for slide 2: first with the sound off, then with its score.
- [ ] Print the student pages; set up the submission spot and the feedback board.

CHOOSING A CLIP ·

My project says: your own, or from YouTube or Vimeo. Page 13 is the student log for either.

- **Your own footage.** A phone video, a school project, or screen capture of a game the student plays. No source questions, and the student already knows the story.
- **A clip you give them.** Provide 3–5 clips you may use and let students choose, as my easier variation says.
- **A clip they find.** Look for sites and licenses that allow reuse, and have the student write the source on the Clip log.

FIVE CHECKS FOR ANY CLIP

- Does it run 2–3 minutes, with 1–2 of them worth scoring?
- Does it have a clear mood a student can name?
- Does it have a few obvious moments to hit?
- Is it simple enough (one place, a few cuts)?
- Does the student know where it came from?

RIGHTS AND CREDIT

Clips belong to their makers. Scoring a clip for a class exercise is different from posting the finished video online. Check the clip site's terms before anyone posts publicly, and credit the maker. This kit gives no legal advice and includes or links to no clip.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Students select and import their video. Study the clip.	Slides 1–6: the hook (a scene with the sound off, then on), what a score does, the seven classes, steps 1 and 2, and choosing a clip. Hand out the project sheet, the Clip log and the Watch notes.	Slides 1–6	p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Plan the score — mark key moments, decide on mood and instrumentation.	Slides 7–11: the timeline, a live demo of markers in Logic, bars and seconds, the score plan, shaping the dynamics. Then students fill in the Score plan and the Cue sheet.	Slides 7–11	p. 15, p. 16, p. 10
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — compose, layer, and sync the score.	Slide 12: compose, starting with the backbone. Then work time.	Slide 12	p. 17
CLASS 4		Slide 13: sync and refine; check each hit point against the picture. Then work time.	Slide 13	—
CLASS 5		Full working day: layer, sync and shape the dynamics. Ask each student to play you one hit point and tell you where it lands.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce, sync audio to video. Prepare presentations.	Slides 14–16: finalize and bounce, what you turn in, the rubric. Students self-score, bounce and post their three questions.	Slides 14–16	p. 21, p. 23
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 17–18: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions.	Slides 17–18	p. 23

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

From my common struggles: steer students to a clip with 1–2 minutes of actual scored content. Slide 6 and the clip checks on page 4 are your script, and page 13 is where students record where their clip comes from.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Slides 12 and 13 open Classes 3 and 4; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: where is your next hit point, and what does the music do there?

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

This connects music production to real-world application in film, TV, games, and advertising. Builds synchronization skills, emotional storytelling through music, and arrangement for narrative purposes.

COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Students pick clips that are too long or too complex. Encourage 1–2 minutes of actual scored content within the 2–3 minute window.
- Students compose music they like rather than music that fits the video. Keep redirecting to the visuals.
- Synchronization is hard. Show them how to use markers in Logic and count frames.
- Students forget about dynamic range — everything is the same volume the whole time.

SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

Easier: Provide 3–5 pre-selected video clips to choose from. Shorter clips (60–90 seconds) reduce overwhelm.

More Advanced: Require at least 3 specific sync points. Add a requirement for original sound effects alongside the score.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Clips too long or complex: slide 6, the clip checks on page 4 and the Clip log (page 13).
- Music they like, not music that fits: the Watch notes (page 14) and the Score plan (page 15) start from the picture.
- Sync is hard: the markers demo (slide 8), the sync guide (page 10) and the Cue sheet (page 16).
- Same volume the whole time: slide 11 and the dynamics row of the Score plan (page 15).

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

MY LIST	IN THIS KIT
YouTube and Vimeo for royalty-free video clips	Not included: no video is included or linked here, because clips belong to their makers. Page 4 shows how to choose a clip students may use, and page 13 is where each student records where theirs came from.
Film scoring examples on YouTube	Not included: search by title. My own scoring-to-picture guidance is on page 11, and slide 2 and the notes for Class 1 say how to use a scene you may show, first with the sound off and then with its score.
Logic Pro markers tutorial for sync points	Not included: no tutorial is in the materials this kit is built from. Page 11 (my “mark your moments” advice), page 10 and page 9 cover markers, SMPTE time and frames; add your own tutorial link.

HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 21). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:

- Technical Skill: ask the student to point to three markers in the Marker track and say which moment each one marks.
- Composition & Structure: look for a shape that follows the picture. Does the music change where the scene changes, and is there a quiet moment as well as a loud one?
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: play the finished video once with the sound off and once on. Check that the clip’s own audio is muted and that dialogue or effects in the clip do not fight the score.
- Documentation & Presentation: the cue sheet (page 16) and the Sync log (page 17) are the evidence. My rubric mentions reflection, so you may want to ask for a sentence or two.

NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

This is one of the most rewarding projects when students nail the sync. Consider showing a before/after of a clip with and without music.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

What changed from the original

CHANGES

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Music for Visual Media** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as “your class page” (checklist items 1 and 2).
- Page numbers are added to steps 1, 2, 3 and 5 (the Clip log, Watch notes, Score plan, Cue sheet and Sync log).
- My three resources are not included; each is named as I wrote it, and the kit says what it offers instead (page 7). No video clip is included or linked. My easier variation (3–5 pre-selected clips) is kept, but no clip list is included, because none was in the materials this kit is built from.
- Page 11 reproduces my “Composing to Picture” advice from my Spooky Tunes project in this kit’s layout. I changed “the video” to “the picture” or “your clip” where needed, and left out its last sentence, which is about that project’s reverb and delay buses.
- My pacing guide’s “Classes 3–5” row spans the Class 3, 4 and 5 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric’s Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 18–20): slide 5 shortens steps 1 and 2, slide 10 shortens step 3, slide 12 shortens step 4, slide 13 shortens step 5, and slide 14 shortens step 6.

KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, goals, the five vocabulary terms, the five requirements, steps (apart from the page numbers), tips, checklist and file name (“Your Name – Music for Visual Media”), the rubric (five categories scored 1–5, /25, the average of the student’s and the teacher’s score), what the project reinforces, the four common struggles, the variations, my day-by-day pacing and my closing note, and the project menu entry quoted on page 3. No requirement or rubric row is added.

NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them (page 11 is from my other materials, as listed above): how to use the kit, the overview and setup pages (including how to choose a clip students may use), the teacher moves and slide numbers in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the Logic quick reference, the sync and timing guide, the worked example (an invented 90-second scene described on paper, not a video), the Clip log, Watch notes, Score plan, Cue sheet and Sync log, the vocabulary page, the presentation planner and the intro deck. None of these adds a requirement or a rubric row.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Logic quick reference

SETUP

Teacher + student

Everything students need in Logic for this project, in one table. Demonstrate markers (slide 8) and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions.

Open the clip	File › Movie › Open Movie, then choose the video file. The picture shows in a movie window; the clip's own sound arrives as a track you can mute.
Frame rate	Project Settings › Synchronization › Frame Rate. Match the video's rate (often 24, 25 or 30) so markers and timecode line up.
Read the time	Switch the LCD to show SMPTE time (Control-click the display for the choices): hours:minutes:seconds:frames.
Markers	View › Show Global Tracks, then use the Marker track. Stop on a key moment, add a marker at the playhead and give it a name, such as "pop" or "cut".
Set the tempo	Click the tempo in the LCD and type a number, or draw changes on the Tempo global track. A bar is 4 × 60 ÷ tempo seconds (page 10).
Snap and grid	Set Snap to Bar, Beat or Division, so regions land on the grid. Turn Snap off to nudge by smaller steps.
Software instruments	Click an empty track, choose Software Instrument, and pick a sound in the Library. Start with one pad or bass as the backbone, then layer in detail.
Volume automation	Press A to show automation, choose Volume and draw swells and dips. This is how a score gets quiet before a big moment.
Sound effects	Record your own sounds, or build effects with a software instrument. Place each one at a marker.
Mute the clip's audio	Mute or delete the video's own audio track, so the original soundtrack does not play under yours.
Bounce	File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. File › Export › Audio to Movie puts the music on the video, or you can play the video and the bounce together.
Zip the project	In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress.

VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

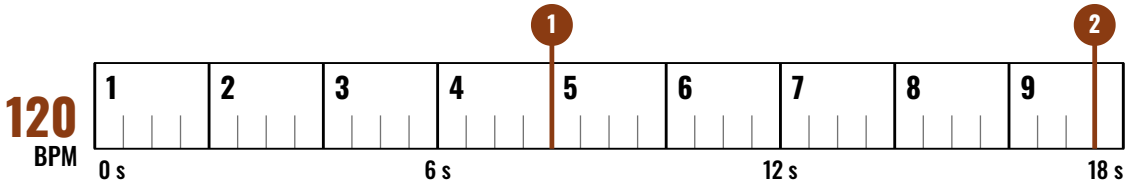
Sync and timing guide

SYNC GUIDE

Teacher + student

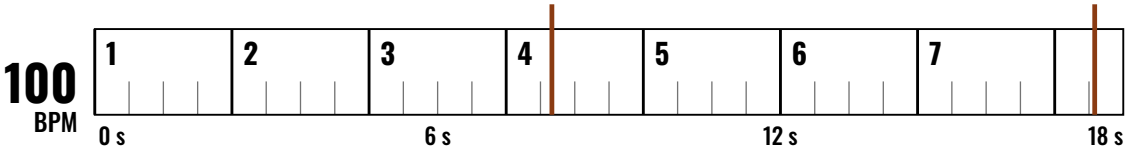
My notes say sync is hard: show students how to use markers and count frames. This page is the explanation to project or print. The numbers use an invented scene at 120 BPM in 4/4.

120 BPM: one bar is 2 seconds



Hit 1 at 0:08 lands on bar 5, beat 1. Hit 2 at 0:17.5 lands on bar 9, beat 4.

100 BPM: one bar is 2.4 seconds



Slow to 100 BPM and hit 1 falls 3.33 bars in, between beats.

SECONDS AND BARS ·

BPM	ONE BEAT	ONE BAR	BARS/MIN
80	750 ms	**3.00 s**	20.0
90	667 ms	**2.67 s**	22.5
100	600 ms	**2.40 s**	25.0
120	500 ms	**2.00 s**	30.0
140	429 ms	**1.71 s**	35.0

One bar in 4/4 = 4 × 60 ÷ BPM seconds. A hit at time t is in bar t ÷ (bar length) + 1.

COUNTING FRAMES ·

VIDEO	ONE FRAME
24 frames per second	41.7 ms
25 frames per second	40.0 ms
30 frames per second	33.3 ms

Timecode is hours:minutes:seconds:frames. At 24 fps, 0:17.5 is 00:00:17:12, or frame 420. Match the project's frame rate to the video's.

FOUR WAYS TO HIT A MOMENT ·

On the beat	The hit lands exactly on a beat or the start of a bar. Easiest to feel; use it for the big moments.
Just before it	A short run-up or pickup leads into the moment, so the music arrives as the picture does.
A stinger	One short sound on the exact frame, such as a bell, a hit or a rise, over a quieter bed of music.
Silence	The music stops, so the picture speaks alone. Often the strongest hit of all.

MOOD: FIRST IDEAS ·

Tense	slow pulse, low register, sparse, notes held and unresolved
Joyful	major key, brighter register, steady and light
Mysterious	quiet, lots of space, unusual sounds, reverb
Sad	slow, minor key, soft, simple melody
Excited	fast, rhythmic, rising lines, getting louder

Rules of thumb, not laws. Trust your ears and the picture.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Composing to picture

TEACHER + STUDENT

Classes 1-2

From the teacher's own materials: the advice I give my own students when they score a picture for the first time. Project it, or hand it out on Class 1 or 2, next to the Watch notes (page 14) and the Cue sheet (page 16).

COMPOSING TO PICTURE ·

Watch before you build	Play the clip twice without touching Logic. What moments stand out? Where does the energy change? What would a sound do to that moment? Write notes before you open a single plug-in.
Mark your moments	Add markers in Logic at the timestamps where you want something to happen. A footstep. A sudden silence. A swell. Having the map in advance stops you from improvising past the moments that matter.
Silence is a tool	If nothing is playing for a moment and then a sound enters, the entry feels enormous. Silence is not dead air; it is tension. Use it deliberately.
Let the picture breathe	You do not need to fill every second with sound. Sparse music over a quiet visual can be more unsettling than a wall of noise. Less is often more here.
Match the energy	If the picture gets more intense, your music should respond. Build toward moments of tension and release from them.

TRY THIS IN CLASS 1

Play a scene you may show to the class with no comment. Then ask: what would you expect to hear if this were a film? Take answers aloud before anyone opens Logic.

WHERE IT CONNECTS

- Markers: demo on slide 8, then the Sync log (page 17).
- Silence and space: the dynamics picture on slide 11.
- Hit points: the Sync guide (page 10).

Film scoring examples are not included. Search by title for a scene you may show.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

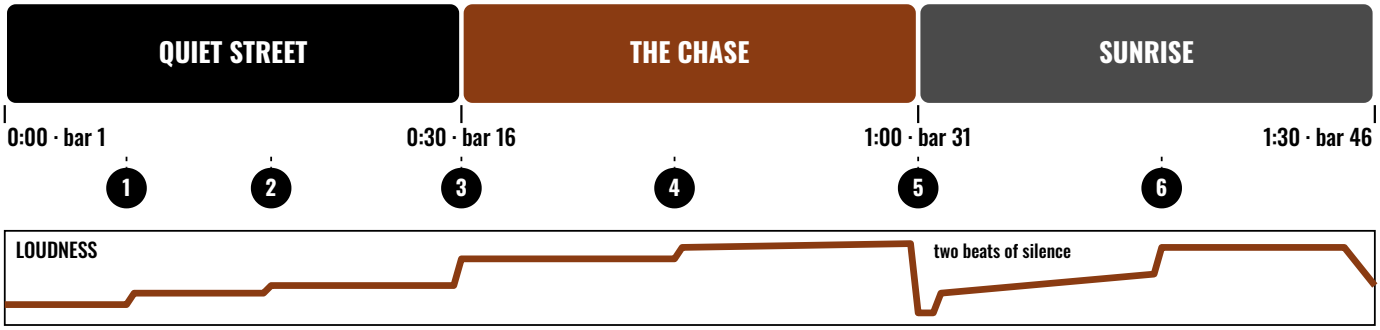
EXAMPLE

Worked example · an invented scene

Teacher

An **invented 90-second scene, described on paper**: no video or audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' clips will differ.

1 · THE SCENE AND ITS HIT POINTS ·



Three scenes of 30 seconds each. At 120 BPM one bar is 2 seconds, so the scene is 45 bars long and each scene is 15 bars.

2 · THE CUE SHEET ·

#	TIME	TIMECODE (24 FPS)	BAR.BEAT	ON SCREEN	THE MUSIC
1	0:08	00:00:08:00	5.1	A door opens	Low pad swells in
2	0:17.5	00:00:17:12	9.4	She sees the balloon	One bell note
3	0:30	00:00:30:00	16.1	Cut to the chase	Drums enter, tempo feel doubles
4	0:44	00:00:44:00	23.1	Turns the corner	Melody steps up a third
5	1:00	00:01:00:00	31.1	The balloon pops	Everything stops for two beats
6	1:16	00:01:16:00	39.1	The sun comes up	Full band returns, bright and wide

3 · READING A ROW

Hit 2 is at 17.5 s. 17.5 ÷ 0.5 = 35 beats. 35 ÷ 4 = 8 bars and 3 beats, so it is bar 9, beat 4. In timecode it is 17 s and 12 frames at 24 fps.

4 · THE SHAPE OF THE SCORE

Scene 1 is quiet and sparse. Scene 2 is loud and driving until the pop at 1:00, then two beats of silence. Scene 3 returns bright. The loudness curve on this page is the plan (slide 11).

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Clip log

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Clip title or description: _____

Where it came from (my own footage, or the site and link): _____

Who made it: _____ **Length:** _____ **Frame rate:** _____

I will score from _____ **to** _____ **(1–2 minutes of real scored content)**

IS THIS CLIP A GOOD CHOICE? ·

- ☐ It runs 2–3 minutes, and 1–2 minutes of it are worth scoring
- ☐ I can name its mood in a word or two
- ☐ It has a few clear moments I can hit
- ☐ It is simple enough: one place, a few cuts, not too many characters
- ☐ I know where it came from, and I may use it for this class project
- ☐ I muted the clip's own music, so only my score plays

WHY I CHOSE IT ·

_____

_____

_____

CREDIT AND RIGHTS NOTE ·

If I share my finished video outside class, I will check the terms of the site the clip came from, and I will credit the person who made it.

Credit line: _____

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Watch notes

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

My tip: watch the video at least 5 times before you start composing. Use a different job for each viewing and write what you notice.

WATCH	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	WHAT I NOTICED
1	Just watch. What happens? What is the story?	
2	Mood: what is the feeling? Colors, light, faces.	
3	Pacing: how fast are the cuts? Where does it speed up or slow down?	
4	Key moments: write the time of each big change or action.	
5	Sound: what do you hear in the clip itself? What is missing?	

The mood in three words: _____

The pacing in one sentence: _____

The emotional arc (how the feeling changes from start to end): _____

_____

Where I might use silence: _____

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Score plan

STUDENT

Class 2

Name _____ Date _____

Step 3: decide where the music builds, drops, shifts and hits visual cues. One row per scene or section of your clip. Start from what the picture does, not from the music you like.

SCENE AND TIME	MOOD	INSTRUMENTS AND SOUNDS	TEMPO AND KEY	LOUDNESS: QUIET, MEDIUM, LOUD, AND HOW IT CHANGES

The backbone I will build first: _____

My main musical idea (a melody, a rhythm or a sound): _____

Where the music is silent or very quiet, and why: _____

Sound effects I might add (optional): _____

CHECK BEFORE YOU COMPOSE

Does my plan change at the places the picture changes? Does it have a quiet part and a loud part?

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Cue sheet

STUDENT

Class 2

Name _____ Date _____

Tempo: _____ **BPM. One bar =** _____ **seconds (4 × 60 ÷ BPM). Frame rate:** _____

Mark every hit point on the video with a marker in Logic, then list it here. Use the markers to read the time. Bar.beat = the bar and beat where the music should hit.

#	TIME (M:SS)	TIMECODE	BAR.BEAT	WHAT HAPPENS ON SCREEN	WHAT THE MUSIC DOES

TIP

Start with at least three hit points. If a hit does not land on a beat, try a different tempo, or hit the moment with a stinger instead (page 10).

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Sync log

Classes 3–6

Name _____ Date _____

Step 5: for each hit point on your cue sheet, play it with the picture. Does the music arrive with the moment? Write how many frames early or late, then fix it.

HIT #	PLANNED BAR.BEAT	ON THE MOMENT?	EARLY (-) OR LATE (+), IN FRAMES	FIXED?
1		☐		☐
2		☐		☐
3		☐		☐
4		☐		☐
5		☐		☐
6		☐		☐
7		☐		☐
8		☐		☐

DYNAMICS CHECK ·

- ☐ There is a quiet part and a loud part
- ☐ The loud parts are loud because of the picture
- ☐ I used silence or space at least once
- ☐ My music is not the same level the whole time

MIX CHECK ·

- ☐ I listened with headphones and with the clip on
- ☐ The clip's own music is muted
- ☐ Any sound effects sit at their markers
- ☐ The video plays from the start with my music

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

Name _____ Date _____

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Digital Music Production | *Open-Ended Project* | 7 class periods

OVERVIEW ·

Score a video. Choose a 2–3 minute video clip and compose an original soundtrack in Logic Pro that complements the visuals. Your music should match the mood, pacing, and emotional arc of the video — and at least some elements should be timed to specific visual moments.

GOALS ·

- Compose music that serves a visual narrative
- Develop synchronization skills — timing music to visual cues
- Explore mood, atmosphere, and pacing through musical choices
- Optionally incorporate sound effects to enhance the audio-visual experience

KEY VOCABULARY ·

Scoring	Writing music designed to accompany and enhance visual media
Synchronization (Sync)	Aligning musical events with specific visual moments on screen
Mood	The emotional tone that music creates — tense, joyful, mysterious, etc.
Sound Design	Creating or selecting sound effects that enhance the visual experience
Hit Point	A specific moment in a video where the music emphasizes a visual event

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Choose a 2–3 minute video clip (your own or from YouTube/Vimeo)
- ☐ Compose a fully formed piece of music that complements the visuals
- ☐ At least some musical elements must be timed to the visuals
- ☐ Sound effects are optional but encouraged
- ☐ Export your composition as .mp3 or .wav and sync it to the video for presentation

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Choose your video** — Find a 2–3 minute clip that inspires you. Import it into Logic. (Clip log: page 13)
2. **Study the video** — Watch it multiple times. Note the mood, pacing, and key visual moments. (Watch notes: page 14)
3. **Plan your score** — Decide where the music builds, drops, shifts, and hits visual cues. (Score plan: page 15; cue sheet: page 16)
4. **Compose** — Build your score in Logic. Start with the backbone and layer in detail.
5. **Sync and refine** — Fine-tune timing to the visuals. Add sound effects if desired. (Sync log: page 17)
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your audio and prepare the video with your music for presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

STUDENT

Project sheet · tips and checklist

Name _____ Date _____

TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- Watch the video at least 5 times before you start composing. You need to know it inside and out.
- Use markers in Logic to flag key visual moments you want to hit.
- Your music doesn't have to fill every second. Silence and space can be powerful.
- Watch movie trailers and film scores for inspiration on how music and visuals interact.

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Music for Visual Media"
- ☐ Video with synced audio ready for presentation
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

NOTES ·

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Music for Visual Media | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Key vocabulary

STUDENT

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The five words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

SCORING — Writing music designed to accompany and enhance visual media

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my video: _____

SYNCHRONIZATION (SYNC) — Aligning musical events with specific visual moments on screen

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my video: _____

MOOD — The emotional tone that music creates — tense, joyful, mysterious, etc.

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my video: _____

SOUND DESIGN — Creating or selecting sound effects that enhance the visual experience

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my video: _____

HIT POINT — A specific moment in a video where the music emphasizes a visual event

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my video: _____

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Present and get feedback

STUDENT

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7

Present & Get Feedback — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

Question 1: _____

Question 2: _____

Question 3: _____

CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

CLASSMATE	THEIR QUESTION	MY ANSWER

BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Music for Visual Media"; .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx uploaded
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 21)

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

TERMS OF USE

Thank you for your purchase!

© 2026 Brian Lotze. Hudson Beat by Brian Lotze. All rights reserved. This purchase gives **one teacher** a license to use this resource (the PDF and the intro deck) with their own students.

YOU MAY

- Print and copy pages for your own classroom and students, year after year.
- Present the intro deck to your own classes and edit it for your own teaching.
- Share pages with your own students through a password-protected class site or learning platform.
- Leave the pages for a substitute teacher who teaches your own students.

YOU MAY NOT

- Share, email or copy this resource for other teachers, a whole school or a district. Additional licenses are available on Teachers Pay Teachers.
- Post any part of it on a public website, shared drive or social media.
- Sell, give away or claim any part of it as your own, or edit it into a new product.

QUESTIONS?

Please use the Q&A tab on the Hudson Beat by Brian Lotze store on Teachers Pay Teachers. If something looks wrong, let me know there and I will fix it.

CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented 90-second scene described on paper), the timeline, bars-and-seconds and dynamics drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
- No video, audio, lyrics, album art, screenshots or chart data are included. YouTube and Vimeo are named only as the owner's resource list names them; they are not affiliated with or endorsing this resource. Padlet is named only as an example of a tool you may already use.
- Text fonts: Oswald (The Oswald Project Authors) and Source Sans 3 (Adobe), SIL Open Font License 1.1.
- Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe compatibility; this resource is not affiliated with or endorsed by Apple.

Designed with the help of digital and AI tools, and checked by hand.